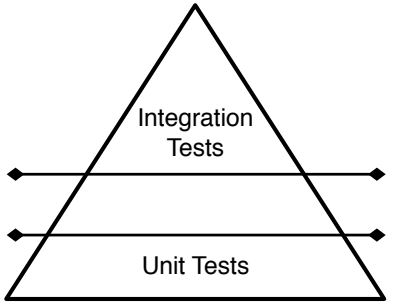
names, but it's still usually enough to tell that, say, you're stuck on a login screen because you forgot to set up a logged-in user. As a shortcut, the capybara-screenshot gem automatically places both an HTML file and an image screenshot in the /tmp directory at the point of failure.

What to Test in an RSpec System Test

Before you make this test pass, take a look at what you're trying to do. In a test-driven process, you would write a system spec to start the process, and then move to writing unit tests to drive the underlying logic. A commonly used metaphor for testing is the *testing pyramid* (see the following figure), where your tests have a relatively large number of unit tests that run quickly and test one small segment of the application, backed by significantly fewer integration tests that run more slowly over the application as a whole. The middle part usually refers to tests that are not quite unit tests, but don't quite test end-to-end integration, such as Rails controller tests. In general, you want to also write relatively few of those tests.

The pyramid metaphor is useful as a guide to the relative number of each kind of test, but it does make it sound a little like the integration tests sit passively on top of a foundation of unit tests. It may be more useful to think of feature-level tests as the frame of a house. Without full feature tests, you can't specify how the different parts of your application work together. Without unit tests there are all kinds of potential holes that bugs can sneak through.



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By far the biggest and easiest trap you can fall into when dealing with integration tests is the temptation to use them like unit tests.

That is to say, don't use feature tests to specify logic that consists largely of internal details of your codebase. One way to tell if your feature test is overly concerned with internal details is to think about what problem in the code would make the test fail. By definition, a feature test can fail in many places, but each test you write should have some specific logic failure that would only be caught by that test.